

2.3.4 WMV

Windows Media Video (WMV) is the name given to a set of codec technologies standardised by Microsoft. This, in comparison to ASF or AVI, is an actual video encoding / decoding format. It is usually packed in an ASF container, especially for distribution on the Internet. It also supports High Definition video encoding onto standard DVDs in a format known as WMV HD.

2.3.5 MPEG (Moving Picture Experts Group)

The MPEG standard is one of the most widely-used video codec formats, and has gone through many revisions. The main versions of this collection of codec technologies are:

MPEG 1: Originally designed to achieve video quality equivalent to VHS, this is one of the most compatible formats being supported by almost all computers and VCD / DVD players. MPEG 1 is also sometimes referred to as the VCD standard in that it supports Video CDs. However, as computer processing power improved and the demands of higher quality and efficiency increased, other standards were developed to replace MPEG 1.

MPEG 2: This standard, originally conceived as a replacement for MPEG 1, is used to encode video and audio for a variety of distribution channels including direct broadcast satellite, cable TV and with some modifications and enhancements for standard DVD and HDV systems. It is also used in the SVCD standard and is fully backwards-compatible to play MPEG 1 video streams.

MPEG 4: This standard is designed to replace both MPEG 1 and 2, and supports all the features of both these standards, while adding some fresh functionality such as VRML (Virtual Reality Markup Language) that enables support for 3D rendering, Digital Rights Management, and various other features. The features are modularised, which gives developers the flexibility to decide what feature they would like to implement and what to leave out. QuickTime and iPod video are some of the popular systems that use MPEG 4.